ADVERTIX · TRACK C · C9 EXPERIMENTS

Live test plan: Meta A/B tests

For testing on production with a real Meta ad account, once Meta approves the App Review. Prepared 30 Oct 2026. Tick each check as Pass or Fail, and write notes beside it.

What C9 covers. C9a: Advertix reads Meta's A/B tests, shows each version's results, and estimates how sure it is about the winner. **C9b:** you start a creative test from Advertix, end a test, and use **Scale the winner** (with Approvals and Undo). **C9c:** each finished test gets a lesson, which the AI Planner uses.

This spends real money. Each test runs real ads on Meta. Keep it small: **3 days**, **1 new creative** (2 versions), and the lowest budget the dialog accepts (the account's daily minimum × number of versions). Ending the test early (section E) stops the split, but **the ads keep running** until you pause them or scale the winner.

0. Before you start (one time)

	Check	Done
0.1	Meta has approved the App Review and the Advertix app is **Live**. In production, go to **Connections** and reconnect Meta so the token comes from the Live app.	☐ Done
0.2	The API and web on production include C5–C9 (calendar, auto-pause, smart hours, experiments).	☐ Done
0.3	**Production schema push** (the Dockerfile doesn't run it). From `apps/api`, with `DATABASE_URL` set to the Railway database: `npx prisma db push`. It adds the `Experiment` table, `AdAccount.metaBusinessId`, and the C6/C7 campaign fields. Then restart the API on Railway.	☐ Done
0.4	Optional: `META_STUDIES_API_VERSION` on Railway. Leave it unset to use **v25.0**. Change it only if Meta says that version isn't available.	☐ Done
0.5	**Test campaign:** a Meta campaign published from Advertix, **Active**, with one ad that has a link (version A). Note its daily budget.	☐ Done
0.6	**Creatives:** at least one image in **Creatives** (version B). Videos work only after they're uploaded to Meta.	☐ Done
0.7	**Second user (for section G):** a teammate with the **Media buyer** role, and a client set to **Ask first** that owns the test campaign, or a second campaign. Optional, but it's the only way to test Approvals.	☐ Done
0.8	Keep the Railway API logs open while testing. Any C9 problem logs a line starting with `[experiments]` or `[sync:meta] experiments failed`.	☐ Done

Timeline at a glance

When	What happens
Day 0	Start the test from Advertix (section B), or create one in Ads Manager (section A). The card shows **starts …**.

+10 minutes	Meta starts the test. After the next sync, the card shows **day 1 of 3**.
Day 1–2	Results, the chance each version is best, and the pill: **"x% so far"** or **"Too close to call"** (section D).
When clear (95%)	The pill turns green (**"x% confident"**), the leader gets a green outline, and **Scale the winner** appears. This may never happen on a small budget, which is fine.
End	End it early (section E) or let it finish. Then scale the winner (F) and save a lesson (H).

A. Reading a test made in Ads Manager (C9a)

This checks that Advertix picks up tests it didn't create. Skip it if you only want to test tests started from Advertix (section B already covers reading).

	Steps	Expected	Result
A1	Before any test exists, open **Experiments** in the sidebar (after Calendar).	Empty state **"No A/B tests yet"** with an **Open Meta Experiments** button that opens Meta's Experiments page.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
A2	In Meta Ads Manager, create an A/B test on this ad account (Experiments → A/B test, or the A/B test button on a campaign). Use 2 versions and the smallest budget.	Meta accepts it.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
A3	In Advertix, run **Sync now** (Campaigns or Connections), then reload Experiments.	The test appears with its name, the subline **client · Meta · 50/50 split · starts/day x of y · goal: …**, and one row per version.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
A4	Sync again.	Still only **one** card for this test (no duplicates).	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
A5	Click **Ads Manager** on the card.	Ads Manager opens on this ad account in a new tab.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail

B. Starting a test from Advertix (C9b)

	Steps	Expected	Result
B1	Experiments → **New test**. Pick the test campaign.	Hint under the campaign: *"Its current ad is version A…"*. The name fills in as **"<campaign>: creative test"**. The budget fills in with at least the minimum for 2 versions.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
B2	Pick 1 image. Set Days to **3**. Leave the budget at the suggested minimum.	The tile shows a check mark and **(1/4)**. Budget hint: *"Split evenly across 2 versions: about … a day each."* **Start test** is enabled.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail

B3	Click **Start test**.	Green toast: *"“…” is set up on Meta. It starts in about 10 minutes."* The dialog closes. The new card shows **starts <date>** and the note *"It starts … Results appear here from its first day."*	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
B4	In Ads Manager, open the campaign's ad set.	A **new ad** using the chosen image, with the **same text, headline, link, call to action and Page** as the current ad.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
B5	In Ads Manager → **Experiments**.	A creative A/B test with the same name, 2 versions at 50/50, 3 days, and the budget you set.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
B6	Advertix → **Activity** (change log).	An entry for the test you created.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
B7	Optional: open the campaign in Advertix → structure.	The new ad is listed with the original one.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail

If Start test fails on live, note the toast text. Advertix should have removed anything it created: check that there's **no extra ad** in the ad set and **no test** in Ads Manager → Experiments. Send me the toast, the `[experiments]` log lines, and an Ads Manager screenshot. The most likely live issue is Meta rejecting the test step itself, for example the API version or where the test is created (Business or personal account).

C. New test dialog checks

These spend nothing and can be done locally too.

	Steps	Expected	Result
C1	Open New test without picking anything.	Start test is off, and the footer says why (*"To start: pick a campaign."*).	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
C2	Set Days to 2, then 31.	*"3 to 30 days."* in red.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
C3	Set the budget below the minimum.	*"At least … a day (… per version)."* Picking more creatives raises the minimum.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
C4	Try to pick a 5th creative.	Nothing happens; the limit is 4.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
C5	Pick a video that isn't on Meta yet.	Error: *"“…” isn't uploaded to Meta yet. Open it in Creatives and upload it first."* Nothing is created on Meta.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail

D. Results and confidence (C9a), days 1–3

	Steps	Expected	Result

D1	The day after starting, sync and open Experiments.	The subline shows **day 1 of 3** (or 2). Each version shows its cost per result, purchases or clicks, CTR, spend, and a **"x% chance it's best"** bar. The leader is marked **· leading**.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
D2	Compare the numbers with Ads Manager for the test dates.	Spend, clicks and results per version roughly match Meta's (small gaps from the last sync time are fine).	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
D3	Read the pill and the Advertix note.	One of: **"x% so far"** with *"At this pace it's clear around …"*; **"Too close to call"**; or a green **"x% confident"** (95%+) with the possible saving from ending now.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
D4	Reload the page a few times.	The percentages **don't change** between reloads (only after a sync).	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
D5	**Judge by**: switch between Auto, Cost / purchase, Cost / click and CTR.	The metric, the bars, the pill and the subline **goal: …** update. It stays after a reload. Auto uses cost per purchase once there are 10+ purchases, otherwise cost per click.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
D6	The **Updated …** time at the bottom of the card.	It matches the last sync.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail

E. End test (C9b)

	Steps	Expected	Result
E1	On a running test, click **End test**.	Confirm: *"End "…" now?"*, and it explains that the versions keep running.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
E2	Confirm.	Toast **"Test ended"**. The card shows **ended <date>**, End test disappears, and **What it showed** appears (section H).	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
E3	After about a minute, check Ads Manager → Experiments.	The test shows as completed. Both ads are **still active**.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
E4	Activity.	An entry for ending the test.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail

F. Scale the winner and Undo (C9b)

The button appears once a test has ended or is conclusive. For a creative test (two ads in one ad set), it pauses the losing ad. When the versions are separate ad sets (tests made in Ads Manager), it also moves the losers' daily budget to the winner's ad set.

	Steps	Expected	Result
F1	On the ended test, as the **Owner**, click **Scale the winner: <version>**.	Confirm: *"Keep <version>?"*, saying it pauses the others and you can undo for 7 days.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail

F2	Confirm.	Toast **"Kept <version>"**. The card shows **Winner scaled just now** and an **Undo** button.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
F3	Ads Manager.	The losing ad (or ad set) is **paused** and the winner is still active. For ad-set versions, the winner's daily budget went up by the losers' budgets.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
F4	Activity.	*"Scaled the winner of "…": kept …, paused 1 other version…"*. Clicking Undo there says *"Undo this from the test on the Experiments page."*	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
F5	Back on the card, click **Undo**.	Toast **"Undone: the other versions are back on"**. In Ads Manager the paused version is active again, and any budget is back to what it was.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
F6	**Undo guard:** scale again, then turn the paused ad back on **in Ads Manager**, sync, and click Undo in Advertix.	Undo refuses: *"Some versions were turned back on since, so Undo would overwrite that…"*. Nothing changes on Meta.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
F7	When you're done, leave the losing version **paused** to stop the spend.	Only the winner is spending.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail

G. Approvals for media buyers (needs 0.7)

	Steps	Expected	Result
G1	As the **Media buyer**, start a New test on the **Ask first** client's campaign.	It doesn't start: the request goes to Approvals and the dialog closes. Nothing appears in Ads Manager yet.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
G2	As the **Owner**, open Activity and approve it.	The new ad and the test are created on Meta (as in B4–B5), and the card appears on Experiments.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
G3	As the Media buyer, click **Scale the winner** on an ended test (any client).	The card shows " ⏳ *Scale the winner is waiting for an owner in Activity.*" Nothing is paused on Meta yet.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
G4	As the Owner, approve it in Activity.	The losers are paused (as in F3), and the card shows Winner scaled with Undo.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
G5	Log in as a **Viewer** (if you have one).	Experiments is readable, but there's no New test, End test, Scale, Judge by change or lesson Save.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail

H. Lessons and the AI Planner (C9c)

	Steps	Expected	Result

H1	On an ended test, look at **What it showed**.	It's pre-filled with Advertix's read, for example *"B beat A: 23% cheaper per purchase (..., Nov 2026)"* or *"No clear difference..."*, with the label *"(Advertix's read: edit and save it)"*.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
H2	Edit the text and click **Save**.	Toast **"Lesson saved"**. **What your tests showed** appears at the top of the page with your lesson. Save is disabled until you change the text again.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
H3	Switch the client switcher between **All clients** and that client.	All clients shows the client's name next to the lesson. Another client's view doesn't show it.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
H4	Open the **AI Planner** for the same client and ask it for a new campaign plan.	The plan's reasoning builds on the lesson, for example by reusing the winning creative style and not repeating what lost.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail

I. Layout and general checks

	Steps	Expected	Result
I1	Client switcher on Experiments.	The kicker shows the client name, and only that client's tests are listed.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
I2	Phone width, or a narrow browser window.	Cards, version rows, buttons and the New test dialog fit without sideways scrolling.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
I3	Dark mode.	The pill, the green winner outline, the bars and the Advertix note are all readable.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail
I4	Keyboard: Tab through a card and the dialog.	Every button and control can be reached and shows a focus ring. Esc closes the dialog.	☐ Pass ☐ Fail

J. Clean up afterwards

- In Ads Manager, pause any test ads you don't want to keep spending, or the whole test campaign.
- The Experiments cards stay as history; nothing needs deleting in Advertix.
- Keep the test lesson only if it's a real one; otherwise clear the text and save so the AI Planner doesn't use it.

What to send me if something fails

1. The check ID (for example **B3**) and the exact toast or error text.
2. The Railway API log lines around that time, especially `[experiments]` and `[sync:meta] experiments failed`. Remove any tokens or keys before sharing.
3. A screenshot of the card, plus Ads Manager (the ad set, or Experiments) if Meta is involved.

Advertix · C9 Experiments live test plan · Google, TikTok and LinkedIn experiments follow once Advertix writes to those platforms. C8 (Snapchat) stays "coming soon".